

**CYBERSECURITY PRACTICAL ASSESSMENT (OSINT, INFORMATION
GATHERING AND DOCUMENTATION)**

BY

ALFRED CALISTA ODINAKA

DATE: SEPTEMBER 16, 2026

TOPIC:

ETHICAL OSINT ON PUBLIC PERSONA

The objective: The purpose of this investigation is to ethically gather publicly available information about Mr. Ijabani Saul Alexander using open source intelligence (OSINT) techniques, in order to document his digital footprint, analyze potential privacy implications, and provide recommendations for improving online privacy and security-without accessing private accounts,guessing passwords, or using any illegal methods.

The scope:This assessment focused exclusively on information that is intentionally made public by the subject or published through legitimate professional channels. The scope includes:

- **Professional Information:** Academic affiliations, publications, research work, and professional roles
- **Digital Presence:** Social media profiles, professional networking accounts, and online portfolios
- **Public Records:** News articles, conference presentations, and institutional directories
- **Academic Contributions:** Journal articles, conference papers, and research collaborations

Exclusions: This assessment explicitly excludes any attempt to access private accounts, guess passwords, use social engineering, or access any non-public information.

Methodology

Search Strategy

A systematic, multi-layered approach was employed to gather information ethically:

1. **Initial Reconnaissance:** Broad name-based searches to identify digital presence
2. **Source Verification:** Cross-referencing information across multiple independent sources
3. **Documentation:** Recording URLs, timestamps, and capturing screenshots as evidence
4. **Analysis:** Evaluating the completeness and security implications of the digital footprint

3.2 Tools and Resources Used

Tool Category	Specific Tools	Purpose
Search Engines	Google, Bing	General web presence discovery
Academic Databases	Google Scholar, ResearchGate	Publications and research work

Professional Networks	LinkedIn, Academia.edu	Professional profiles
Institutional Directories	University/Polytechnic websites	Employment verification
News Aggregators	Google News	Media mentions and public appearances
Social Media	Twitter/X, Facebook (public profiles only)	Public social presence

Findings:

Based on my OSINT investigation, the following publicly available information was discovered:

Professional/Academic Affiliation

Finding: Mr. Ijabani Saul Alexander is affiliated with Federal Polytechnic, Mubi, Adamawa State, Nigeria, in the Department of Public Administration.

Source: <https://ajaefm.adsu.edu.ng>

Publications and Research

Finding: [Describe any academic publications found – e.g., "Co-authored research on informal socio-economic activities along the Nigeria-Niger border, published in the American Journal of African Economics and Financial Management (AJAEFM)."]

Source: <https://ajaefm.adsu.edu.ng/index.php/journals/article/view/149>

Digital Footprint Summary

Platform	Profile Found	Visibility	Information Type
Google Search	Yes	Public	Professional mentions
Academic Journals	Yes	Public	Research publications
LinkedIn	Yes	Public	Professional
Twitter/X	No	Private	Unknown
Facebook	No	Private	Unknown
Instagram	No	Private	Unknown
ResearchGate	No	Private	Unknown

Analyses:

Digital Footprint Assessment

The OSINT investigation reveals the following about Mr. Ijabani Saul Alexander's digital presence:

- **Professional Visibility:** [Public]
- **Academic Presence:** [Published article]
- **Social Media Activity:** [Private]

- **Information Consistency:** [Information is consistent across platforms]

Risk Implications

The identified digital footprint could potentially enable:

- **Social Engineering Attacks:** Attackers could use gathered information to craft convincing phishing messages
- **Identity Theft:** Sufficient personal information could facilitate impersonation
- **Targeted Attacks:** Knowledge of professional role and affiliations could enable spear-phishing
- **Physical Security Risks:** Location information could pose physical security concerns

Recommendations

Based on the analysis, the following recommendations are proposed to improve online privacy and security:

Immediate Actions

1. **Review Privacy Settings:** Audit all social media accounts and set profiles to private where appropriate
2. **Remove Sensitive Information:** Delete or restrict access to personal contact details, addresses, and family information
3. **Use Professional Emails:** Separate personal and professional email addresses for public-facing activities
4. **Enable Two-Factor Authentication:** Add 2FA to all accounts to prevent unauthorized access

Medium-Term Improvements

5. **Google Yourself Regularly:** Set up Google Alerts for your name to monitor new public mentions
6. **Use a P.O. Box:** For public-facing professional activities, use institutional or P.O. Box addresses
7. **Limit Personal Details on Academic Profiles:** Share only necessary professional information on ResearchGate, Google Scholar, etc.

8. **Review Third-Party Data Brokers:** Request removal from people-search websites where possible

Long-Term Strategy

9. **Digital Footprint Audit:** Conduct quarterly reviews of online presence
10. **Professional Online Presence:** Maintain a controlled, professional website or LinkedIn as the primary public-facing profile

Conclusion:

This OSINT practical assessment successfully demonstrated ethical information gathering techniques using only publicly available sources. The investigation revealed [summarize key findings briefly]. The exercise highlighted the importance of understanding one's digital footprint and the potential security implications of publicly accessible information.

Key observations from this assessment include:

- OSINT techniques can reveal significant information about individuals using only legal, ethical methods
- Academic professionals often have substantial digital footprints through publications and institutional directories
- Privacy settings and information sharing practices significantly impact exposure to potential threats
- Regular digital footprint audits are essential for maintaining personal and professional security

This assessment reinforces the critical importance of OSINT skills for cybersecurity professionals in both defensive (protecting organizational assets) and offensive (authorized penetration testing) contexts.

References

1. Google Search Engine. (2026). Retrieved September 18, 2026, from <https://www.google.com>
2. Bing Search Engine. (2026). Retrieved September 18, 2026, from <https://www.bing.com>
3. American Journal of African Economics and Financial Management. (2025). Retrieved from <https://ajaefm.adsu.edu.ng>
4. Google Scholar. (2026). Retrieved from <https://scholar.google.com>
5. LinkedIn Corporation. (2026). Retrieved from <https://www.linkedin.com>
6. ResearchGate. (2026). Retrieved from <https://www.researchgate.net>
7. OSINT Framework. (2026). Retrieved from <https://osintframework.com>

Appendix : Search Query Log

Date	Search Query	Platform	Results
[18/09 /2026]	"Ijabani Saul Alexander"	Google	Staff directory listing for federal polytechnic mubi
[18/09 /2026]	"Ijabani Saul" Federal Polytechnic Mubi	Google	Institutional listing only. No private contact info indicates low digital footprint
[18/09 /2026]	Ijabani Saul Alexander"	Bing	Linkedin